home, limp through the door, and choose to go as far away from cricket as I can.

We are in Greece when the Ashes unfolds as Jofra Archer lands a bouncer on Steve Smith's head at Lord's, leaving him splayed out on the floor. Then I'm in the dressing room, watching in awe along with everyone else as Ben Stokes plays maybe the greatest innings of all time to win the Headingley Test. He had done the same thing earlier in the year – alongside Jos Buttler – to win the World Cup for the first time for England. It's an odd sensation to be both on the outside and the inside during these moments, still the leader of the attack in theory, but injured and out of view as cricket comes back into focus again. It's like the Ashes of 2005 and the stress fracture the year that followed repeating themselves all over again. There is no doubt in my mind, nothing that tells me I've had enough. I will get myself fit, work harder than ever before and as if nothing has happened before and those 564 wickets are now wiped clean, prove I'm all the bowlers I've ever been. No outside definition of the boundaries of age will stop me.